

301 Redirect Strategy — ServiceLinePro Migration

This document outlines the approach for preserving SEO equity and existing URLs when migrating from the previous website to the new Astro site on Cloudflare Pages.

Goals

1. **Preserve search rankings** — Every indexed URL that changes must return a `301 Moved Permanently` response pointing to its new location.
 2. **Maintain backlink value** — External links to old URLs continue to pass authority.
 3. **Avoid soft-404s** — No old URL should land on a generic 404 page without a redirect.
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Implementation Method

Cloudflare Pages supports redirects via a `_redirects` file placed in the build output (`public/` directory in Astro, copied to `dist/` at build time).

File: `public/_redirects`

Format (one rule per line):

```
/old-path /new-path 301
```

Example Rules

```
# Service pages
/seo-services          /services/local-seo  301
/seo                   /services/local-seo  301
/local-seo             /services/local-seo  301
/google-ads            /services/ppc         301
/ppc                   /services/ppc         301
/web-design-services   /services/web-design  301
/website-design        /services/web-design  301
/tv-advertising        /services/tv-streaming 301
/streaming             /services/tv-streaming 301

# Core pages
/about-us              /about                301
/contact-us            /contact              301
/faqs                  /faq                  301
/schedule              /booking              301
/book-a-call           /booking              301

# Blog & resources (pattern)
/blog/*                /blog/:splat          301
/case-study/*          /case-studies/:splat  301

# Catch-all for old service subpages
/services/seo          /services/local-seo  301
/services/google-ads   /services/ppc         301
```

Note: The example rules above are templates. Before launch, audit the previous site's indexed URLs using Google Search Console → Coverage report and/or `site:servicelinepro.com` search to build the final list.

Pre-Launch Checklist

- [] **Crawl the old site** — Use Screaming Frog or `sitemap.xml` to inventory all live URLs.
- [] **Map old → new** — For every old URL, determine the best matching new URL.
- [] **Add rules to `public/_redirects`** — Commit the file to the repo.
- [] **Test redirects locally** — Use `npx wrangler pages dev dist` to verify redirect behaviour.
- [] **Verify post-launch** — After DNS switch, spot-check the top 20 pages with `curl -I` to confirm 301 responses.
- [] **Monitor Search Console** — Watch for crawl errors and coverage drops for 30 days post-launch.

Cloudflare Pages Limits

- **Static redirects:** Up to 2,000 rules in `_redirects`.
- **Dynamic redirects:** For more complex patterns, use Cloudflare Bulk Redirects (available in the dashboard under Rules → Redirect Rules) which support regex and thousands of rules.

Fallback: Custom 404 Page

Create `src/pages/404.astro` with:

- Clear messaging that the page has moved
- Search functionality or links to top pages
- Contact info so visitors can still reach ServiceLinePro

This ensures any unmapped old URL still provides a useful experience.